

J for math

J is a powerful esoteric language that makes it very simple to perform complicated mathematical operations

Esolangs.org

Has an extensive list of esoteric languages with examples and links to compilers / interpreters and guides

Some of the strangest esoteric languages

Esoteric Oxford English Dictionary: intended for or likely to be understood by only a small number of people with a specialized knowledge or interest

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Developers can be really fun when they want to be, they just have strange ways of showing it. Such as creating even more programming languages in their spare time, just for fun.

There are a number of esoteric languages, some created out of specialized needs, some for experimentation with a concept, and others purely for fun. We often encounter esoteric languages that boggle our minds and we always keep a note, so that one day we can share our mind-boggling experience with our readers. Well, here are some of the most mind-boggling languages that we ever came across!

CPL

<http://c-p-l.sourceforge.net/>

Brian A. Egge, developer of CPL: "CPL was created out of a need for advance commenting features, not found in any other existing programming language. I was fusterated[sic] with out dated rules, and limited ability to write comments into my existing code. What I needed was an environment where I could write details comments in my code."

CPL, or Comment Programming Language was designed out of a need for simplifying code documentation and allowing for a rich variety of commenting syntax. The developer took to this mission in a most astute manner by removing any and all non-comment syntax from the language. What's left behind is a lean, mean "programming" language that accepts comments in nearly all possibly syntax formats, whether it be those from Windows batch files, Visual Basic, C++ or SQL.

Example Program:

```
//NONE POSSIBLE!
```

Pro: This is possibly the easiest language in which you can document what exactly your lack of code is not doing

Cons: The only way to write a "Hello World" program is probably to exploit a bug in the compiler to cause a buffer overflow that causes the your code to be executed.

Whitespace

<http://compsoc.dur.ac.uk/whitespace/>

Do you use long words while typing? Feel like your spacebar key is under-used? Learn Whitespace to balance it all out. This is a programming language that relies entirely on whitespace characters, such that a Whitespace program in notepad will look exactly like an empty file.

Whitespace uses only the space character, the tab character, and the linefeed character (Enter). Combinations of these characters form the basic keywords of this language. Whitespace can be used to code some rather complex programs, if you have the patience.

"Most modern programming languages do not consider white space characters (spaces, tabs and newlines) syntax, ignoring them, as if they weren't there. We consider this to be a gross injustice to these perfectly friendly members of the character set. Should they be ignored, just because they are invisible? Whitespace is a language that seeks to redress the balance. Any non whitespace characters are ignored; only spaces, tabs and newlines are considered syntax."

Example Program:

Oh wait, you can't read that can you? But we printed it! Honest.

Pro: 100% savings on toner when you print Whitespace programs

Cons: All your hard work reimplementing the Crysis engine in Whitespace will go unnoticed by your boss.

Shakespeare Programming Language

<http://shakespearelang.sourceforge.net/>

Alas that programmers type more than the average playwright, yet their words count less. What if, however, you could write an award-winning play, and best-selling software all in one go?

The Shakespeare Programming Language allows one to write code in the form of a properly formatted play. The programming language was devised We need add nothing more that what the developers have to say for themselves.

From the Shakespeare Programming Language project page:

"A programming language created with the design goal to make the source code resemble Shakespeare plays."

"The characters in the play are variables. If you want to assign a character, let's say Hamlet, a negative value, you put him and another character on the stage and let that character insult Hamlet."

"Input and output is done by having someone tell a character to listen their heart and speak their mind. The language contains conditionals, where characters ask each other questions, and jumps, where they decide to go to a specific act or scene. Characters are also stacks that can be pushed and popped."

Child's play!

Already know all this stuff? Digit is looking for developers to write articles and code for us. Send in CVs to editor@thinkdigit.com and also check out the other openings on Page 117 of this issue

Example Program (Hello world fragment):

Romeo, a young man with a remarkable patience.

Juliet, a likewise young woman of remarkable grace.

Ophelia, a remarkable woman much in dispute with Hamlet.

Hamlet, the flatterer of Andersen